



TRYING TO CONNECT
The works on display include tactile and virtual artworks that explore the paradoxes of modernity; Doug Aitken (inset)





EXHIBITION ▼

TIME **MACHINE**

A MULTIMEDIA EXHIBITION in Mumbai explores how we navigate time and space—and our place within it

Spread over three floors of the Art House at the Nita Mukesh Ambani Cultural Centre, Doug Aitken's *Under the Sun* takes viewers on a temporal journey across three narratives—Past, Present and Future. This is the first exhibition in India for the American multimedia artist and filmmaker and features multiple site-specific commissions. The exhibition is curated by Mafalda Kahane and Roya Sachs and produced by Elizabeth Edelman, partners of the creative house TRIADIC.

On the first floor, Past draws viewers into a tactile landscape of raw materials—carved wood, reclaimed debris, woven fabrics, embroidery and stained-glass—all sourced locally. In the centre, spiralling wooden boats are encircled by six monumental human figures, while the walls feature six large-scale textile works, each tracing a sacred Indian river as veins across hands. The installation is the result of a two-year collaboration between Aitken's studio and more than a dozen skilled Indian artisans. Walk up to the second floor, where Present transforms the gallery into a kaleidoscopic environment of mirrored walls and shifting screens inside Aitken's 'New Era' video installation. The film explores the history of the mobile phone with its inventor Martin Cooper pondering questions of human connection and identity. It's a striking installation that places mobile phones in contrast with vast natural landscapes, provoking reflection on the cultural and social shifts shaped by technology.

On the third floor, Future presents 'Lightfall/Other Worlds', a new immersive light sculpture by Aitken, commissioned specifically for the exhibition. The surreal exhibit is a luminous orb with a vertical core of hundreds of suspended LED tubes carrying smooth waves of light. The abstract sphere continuously expands and contracts above a rustic wooden flooring, enveloping viewers in a hypnotic drone soundscape, perhaps representing a pulsing abstraction of the future. ■

—Prachi Joshi
The exhibition is on till Feb. 22